

Ecclesiastical Latin

Reference Grammar and Core Missal Lexicon

A retrieval companion for all 46 learning modules

Definitions, paradigms, syntax summaries, genre guidance, core vocabulary, and a repeatable parsing checklist. Form a hypothesis before consulting the reference.

Corpus 1962 *Missale Romanum*; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers

Method Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand

Pacing Consult after an unaided hypothesis while working through the modules

Document Reference companion

Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law

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Part I

Reference Grammar and Lexicon

CHAPTER 1

How to use this reference

This volume is a retrieval aid, not a substitute for deciding what a form does in its sentence. When stuck, use this order:

1. mark every finite verb and conjunction;
2. divide the sentence into clauses;
3. identify each word's possible dictionary form and morphology;
4. use agreement, government, and clause structure to eliminate impossible analyses;
5. consult the relevant table below; and
6. use a dictionary only after writing a lemma hypothesis.

The *Missale Romanum* (1962) normally prints neither macrons nor learner aids and uses consonantal *i* rather than *j*. This reference follows that practice and omits macrons except when vowel quantity itself resolves a form or appears in a cited dictionary convention. The ligatures *æ* and *œ* may be alphabetized or typed as *ae* and *oe*.

CHAPTER 2

Core grammatical vocabulary

These are working definitions for the whole course. Return here whenever a lesson uses a familiar English word—such as “case,” “object,” or “perfect”—in a technical sense. A useful definition states the decisive features of a concept; an example alone does not define it.

2.1 Words, forms, and analysis

Definition — lexeme. A single vocabulary item considered across all of its inflected forms and senses. *amo*, *amas*, and *amavit* are forms of one lexeme, conventionally cited as *amo*.

Definition — lemma (or headword). The conventional citation form under which a lexeme is listed in a dictionary. A Latin noun lemma is normally nominative singular; a verb lemma is normally first-person singular present indicative. The lemma identifies the lexeme but is not necessarily the form printed in a sentence.

Definition — word form. The actual shape of a word in a text, including its inflectional information. The form *gratiarum* belongs to the lemma *gratia* and encodes genitive plural.

Do not confuse a lemma with a word form. The lemma is the lookup label; the word form is the evidence that must be analyzed in its sentence. Do not search for *gratiarum* as though it were a separate vocabulary item.

Definition — inflection. A change of form that expresses grammatical features such as case, number, person, tense, voice, or mood without creating a new lexeme. *laudat* and *laudantur* are inflections of the same verb.

Definition — stem and ending. The **stem** is the base to which inflectional material is added; an **ending** is the inflectional material that signals one or more grammatical features. Sound changes can blur the boundary, so a surface form is not always divisible by simply cutting off its last letters.

Definition — paradigm. An ordered display of the inflected forms of a model word. A paradigm is a retrieval map: it shows which feature bundle selects which form.

Definition — morphology. The grammatical structure of word forms: how stems, endings, and other changes express features. To give the morphology of *laudantur* is to identify it as third-person plural, present, passive, indicative.

Definition — syntax. The relations by which words and clauses function together in a sentence—for example, subject and predicate, agreement, government, modification, subordination, and coordination.

Definition — meaning (or sense). What a form, phrase, or sentence communicates in its context. Morphology and syntax constrain meaning, but a dictionary gloss does not by itself decide the contextual sense.

Do not confuse morphology with syntax. Morphology asks what grammatical information a form carries; syntax asks what that form is doing in relation to other forms. The same morphology can serve different syntactic functions.

2.2 Parts and structures of a sentence

Definition — part of speech. A class of words defined by shared grammatical behavior. The principal classes used here are noun, pronoun, adjective, verb, adverb, preposition, conjunction, and particle. Part of speech is what kind of word something is; syntactic function is the job it performs in this sentence.

Part of speech	Working definition	Diagnostic
Noun	An inflected word that names or designates an entity, substance, quality, or concept	Has case, number, and lexical gender; may head a noun phrase.
Pronoun	A word whose reference is supplied by speaker, context, or an antecedent	Declines for its syntactic role; reference must be traced.

Part of speech	Working definition	Diagnostic
Adjective	An inflected modifier or predicate that attributes a quality, class, quantity, or identification to a noun or pronoun	Agrees in gender, number, and case with the word it modifies or predicates.
Verb	A word that predicates an action, process, occurrence, or state	A finite form can organize a clause and is marked for person and number.
Adverb	An indeclinable modifier of a verb, adjective, another adverb, or a whole assertion	Expresses such relations as manner, degree, time, or place without case agreement.
Preposition	An indeclinable word that heads a phrase and governs a stated case	Read the preposition and its case-governed complement together.
Conjunction	An indeclinable word that links coordinate units or introduces a subordinate clause	Determine what units it joins and whether one depends on another.
Particle	An indeclinable form whose force chiefly organizes, qualifies, or responds to discourse	Its function may be pragmatic rather than a concrete English gloss.

Definition — head, modifier, complement, and adjunct. The **head** is the central word that determines the kind of phrase. A **modifier** describes or restricts a head. A **complement** completes a relation selected or expected by its head; an **adjunct** adds optional circumstance. In *miserere nobis*, the verb is the predicate head and *nobis* completes its customary construction.

Definition — phrase. A word or group of words organized around a head but not, as a unit, making a predication with its own subject. *in saecula saeculorum* is a prepositional phrase.

Definition — clause. A grammatical unit containing a predicate, its dependents, and an expressed or understood subject. Its predicate is normally a finite verb, but a non-finite form with its own subject and argument structure may be analyzed as a subordinate non-finite clause. A clause may stand as the main assertion or depend on another clause.

Definition — sentence. A complete independent unit of discourse that may contain one clause or several. Liturgical punctuation helps reading but does not replace the search for predicates and clause relations.

Do not confuse a phrase with a clause. A phrase is organized around a head without its own subject–predicate relation. A clause makes a predication with an expressed or understood subject; that predication is usually finite but can be non-finite.

Definition — subject and predicate. The **subject** is the element about which a clause predicates, ordinarily a nominal word, phrase, or substantive clause, and it ordinarily controls the finite verb's person and number. The **predicate** is what the clause asserts of that subject, centered on its verb. Latin may leave a pronominal subject unexpressed because the verb ending identifies it.

Definition — object. A nominal complement selected by a verb. A **direct object** completes a transitive verb and normally bears the accusative without a preposition; an **indirect object** commonly bears the dative and marks the recipient, beneficiary, or person affected. Not every accusative is an object, and not every dative is an indirect object.

Definition — copula and predicate complement. A **copula**, especially a form of *sum*, links the subject to a **predicate noun** or **predicate adjective** that identifies or describes it. A predicate noun is normally nominative because it refers to the subject, not accusative as a direct object.

2.3 Inflectional features and relations

Definition — declension. A pattern by which nouns, adjectives, and pronouns form their cases and numbers. A noun's declension describes its inflectional pattern; it does not state the noun's function in a particular sentence.

Definition — conjugation. A pattern by which verbs build forms from their stems and express person, number, tense, voice, and mood. Principal parts reveal stems that the conjugation label alone cannot predict.

Do not confuse declension with case. Declension is the family of forms a nominal word uses; case is a grammatical feature of one form in context. "Third declension" does not mean "third case."

Definition — case. An inflectional feature of nouns, pronouns, adjectives, and participles that helps mark syntactic relations such as subject, possession, recipient, object, means, or address. An ending may represent more than one case, so syntax must decide among the possibilities.

Definition — number. The grammatical contrast between singular and plural. Number belongs both to nominal forms and to finite verbs; agreement links the two where a subject controls its verb.

Definition — grammatical gender. The lexical classification of a noun as masculine, feminine, or neuter, which controls agreeing forms. Gender is not a visual ending and is not identical with natural sex.

Definition — person. The verbal and pronominal category distinguishing speaker (first person), addressee (second), and anyone or anything else (third). Person and number together identify a finite verb's grammatical subject when no separate pronoun is printed.

Definition — agreement. The matching of grammatical features between related words. An adjective agrees with its noun in gender, number, and case; a finite verb ordinarily agrees with its subject in person and number. Agreement does not require identical-looking endings.

Definition — government. The requirement by which a head word or construction selects the case or form of its complement. *cum* governs the ablative; *ad* governs the accusative.

Do not confuse agreement with government. In agreement, one word copies relevant features from another; in government, a head requires its dependent to take a particular form. The ablative in *cum gratia* is governed, not agreed.

Definition — antecedent and referent. An **antecedent** is the expression to which a pronoun is grammatically or textually linked. A **referent** is the person, thing, or idea to which an expression points in context. A pronoun may have a referent without a separately printed antecedent.

2.4 Verbal categories

Definition — principal parts. The conventional set of forms from which a verb's required stems can be recovered. They are learned together because a conjugation label predicts the present system more reliably than it predicts the perfect or participial stems.

Definition — finite verb. A verb form marked for person and number and for mood, tense, and voice, capable of serving as the predicate center of a clause. *laudamus* and *laudent* are finite.

Definition — non-finite verb form. A verbal form not marked for a personal subject in the same way as a finite verb. Infinitives, participles, gerunds, gerundives, and supines retain verbal properties but depend on another word or construction.

Definition — tense and relative time. **Tense** is a grammatical form that combines temporal and aspectual information. **Relative time** locates an infinitive or participle as simultaneous with, prior to, or subsequent to the time of its governing verb, rather than automatically relative to the present moment.

Definition — aspect. The speaker's grammatical viewpoint on an event, such as ongoing or incomplete versus viewed as a whole or completed. Latin tense names do not always map one-for-one onto English clock time.

Do not confuse tense with time. Tense is a form in the grammatical system; time is the temporal relation understood in context. A Latin perfect form can have more than one natural English tense rendering.

Definition — voice. The grammatical relation between a verb's subject and the event. Active voice normally presents the subject as actor or experiencer; passive voice normally presents it as the affected participant. Deponent verbs use passive morphology but do not thereby have passive meaning.

Definition — mood. The grammatical category by which a finite verb presents an assertion, possibility, wish, command, purpose, consequence, or another speaker-framed relation. The indicative, subjunctive, and imperative are the principal finite moods used in this course.

Do not confuse mood with clause type. Mood is a form of the verb; clause type is the syntactic relation of the whole clause. A subjunctive form does not identify its own use until its governing context and signals are examined.

2.5 Reading and composition terms

Definition — parse. To identify a form's lemma and morphology and to state its syntactic function with evidence from the sentence. Naming an ending without explaining the function is incomplete parsing.

Definition — structural translation. A deliberately close English rendering that exposes Latin clause relations, reference, and relative time even when the result is inelegant. It is a diagnostic stage, not the final goal.

Definition — direct reading. Understanding a Latin text through its Latin forms, syntax, vocabulary, and context without using a memorized or facing English translation as the medium of comprehension. Dictionary consultation for a genuinely unknown lexeme is compatible with direct reading.

Definition — controlled, guided, and free composition. **Controlled composition** changes specified features within a supplied model; **guided composition** supplies part of the structure, vocabulary, or content; **free composition** requires the writer to choose and defend the structure and wording. The stages differ in support, not in the requirement for accurate Latin.

Definition — idiom. A conventional wording or construction whose normal force cannot be recovered safely by substituting the first English gloss for each word. An idiom must be learned with its construction and context.

Definition — genre and register. A **genre** is a recurring kind of text with characteristic purposes and structures, such as Collect, Gospel, or rubric. A **register** is a variety of language associated with a setting or use, such as biblical, liturgical, or juridical Latin.

Definition — ellipsis. The omission of an element recoverable from grammar or context. Supply an omitted word only when the construction requires or strongly licenses it, and mark the supplement as supplied.

Definition — hyperbaton. A marked separation or rearrangement of syntactically connected words. Agreement and government, not adjacency, reveal the connection.

Definition — allusion. A wording that activates another text or context without fully quoting or naming it. Identifying an allusion requires verbal evidence and an explanation of what the recalled context contributes.

Definition — calque. A phrase or construction produced by closely copying the structure of another language. Biblical and ecclesiastical Latin may contain established calques; an English-shaped novelty is not justified merely because its individual Latin words are correct.

2.6 Quick contrast index

When two labels compete, ask the deciding question rather than choosing by English resemblance.

Do not confuse	Distinction	Deciding question
Lemma / word form	dictionary identity / shape in this text	What do I look up, and what features does the printed form encode?
Part of speech / function	kind of word / job in this sentence	What is it by grammatical behavior, and what does it do here?
Declension / case	inflectional family / feature in context	Which paradigm supplies the forms, and which relation selects this form?
Gender / natural sex	grammatical class / real-world characteristic	What agreement does the noun require?
Agreement / government	matched features / selected complement form	Is a word copying features or requiring a case?
Phrase / clause	headed unit / subject–predicate unit	Does this unit make a predication with its own expressed or understood subject?
Subject / actor	syntactic controller / semantic participant	What agrees with the finite verb, and who performs the action?
Accusative / direct object	morphological case / one possible function	Is the accusative selected as object, infinitive subject, extent, motion, or another use?
Tense / time	grammatical form / contextual temporal relation	What is the Latin form, and when is the event understood relative to its reference point?
Voice / meaning	grammatical alignment / contextual sense	Is the form active or passive, and is the lexeme deponent?
Mood / use	verbal form / construction in context	What mood is marked, and what licenses its force in this clause?
Structural translation / direct reading	diagnostic rendering / Latin-led comprehension	Am I exposing the syntax or understanding without an English intermediary?
Genre / register	kind of text / variety of language	What task does the text perform, and what linguistic conventions does its setting favor?

CHAPTER 3

Dictionary forms and notation

Definition — dictionary entry. The lemma together with enough additional forms, grammatical labels, and senses to identify the lexeme and build or recognize its inflections. Read the whole entry: the first English gloss is not a definition of every contextual use.

Class	Entry pattern	What it supplies
Noun	<i>gratia</i> , -æ <i>f.</i>	nominative singular, genitive singular, gender; the genitive reveals declension and stem.
Adjective, 1/2	<i>sanctus</i> , -a, -um	nominatives for masculine, feminine, and neuter.
Adjective, 3	<i>fidelis</i> , -e; <i>felix</i> , -icis	nominative forms and/or genitive singular revealing the stem.
Verb	<i>amo</i> , <i>amare</i> , <i>amavi</i> , <i>amatum</i>	first-person present, present infinitive, first-person perfect, and supine/perfect-passive stem.
Deponent	<i>sequor</i> , <i>sequi</i> , <i>secutus sum</i>	passive-looking principal parts with active or middle meaning.
Preposition	<i>ad</i> + <i>acc.</i> ; <i>cum</i> + <i>abl.</i>	case governed.
Indeclinable	<i>et conj.</i> ; <i>non adv.</i>	part of speech; the form does not inflect.

Common abbreviations: *nom.* nominative, *gen.* genitive, *dat.* dative, *acc.* accusative, *abl.* ablative, *voc.* vocative; *sg./pl.*; *m./f./n.*; *pres.*, *imperf.*, *fut.*, *perf.*, *plup.*, *fut. perf.*; *ind.*, *subj.*, *impv.*, *inf.*, *ptcp.*; *act./pass.*

CHAPTER 4

Nouns

Definition — noun. A case-inflected word that can head a noun phrase and designate a person, thing, substance, quality, action, or concept. A Latin noun's dictionary information includes gender and the genitive needed to find its stem and declension.

4.1 Case questions

Definition — case use. The particular syntactic or semantic relation expressed by a case form in its sentence, such as subject for a nominative, possessor for a genitive, or means for an ablative. The name of the case does not by itself identify the use.

Do not confuse a case ending with a case use. An ending supplies one or more possible morphological analyses; the sentence selects the function. For example, -æ may represent several cases, and even an unambiguous ablative can express several different relations.

Case	Core work	First diagnostic question
Nominative	subject; predicate nominative	What is being predicated about, what controls agreement, or what is identified?
Genitive	possessor; whole; description; object with certain words	Of whom or of what? What noun governs it?
Dative	indirect object; reference; possession; agent with gerundive	To or for whom? Whose interest is involved?
Accusative	direct object; motion toward; extent; subject of infinitive	What receives the action? Is an infinitive controlling it?
Ablative	separation, source, means, manner, cause, comparison, location, time, agent	Which ablative relation best explains the context?
Vocative	direct address	Who is being addressed?

4.2 First declension: *gratia, gratiæ f.*

	Singular	Plural
Nominative	gratia	gratiæ
Genitive	gratiæ	gratiarum
Dative	gratiæ	gratiis
Accusative	gratiam	gratias
Ablative	gratia	gratiis
Vocative	gratia	gratiæ

Mostly feminine. Frequent masculine occupational nouns include *propheta*, *-æ* and *evangelista*, *-æ*. *Pœnitentiarius*, *-i* is instead second declension.

4.3 Second declension

	dominus		puer		verbum	
	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.
Nom.	dominus	domini	puer	pueri	verbum	verba
Gen.	domini	dominorum	pueri	puerorum	verbi	verborum
Dat.	domino	dominis	puero	pueris	verbo	verbis
Acc.	dominum	dominos	puerum	pueros	verbum	verba
Abl.	domino	dominis	puero	pueris	verbo	verbis
Voc.	domine	domini	puer	pueri	verbum	verba

Neuter rule: nominative and accusative are identical; plural nominative and accusative end in *-a*. Masculine *-ius* normally has vocative *-i*; *filius* gives *fili*.

4.4 Third declension

Find the stem by removing *-is* from the genitive singular. Endings:

Masculine/feminine			Neuter		
	sg.	pl.		sg.	pl.
Nom.	variable	-es	variable	-a / -ia	
Gen.	-is	-um / -ium	-is	-um / -ium	
Dat.	-i	-ibus	-i	-ibus	
Acc.	-em	-es	= nom.	= nom.	
Abl.	-e / -i	-ibus	-e / -i	-ibus	
Voc.	= nom. generally	= nom.	= nom.	= nom.	

rex, regis m.		civis, -is c.		mare, -is n.		
	sg.	pl.		sg.	pl.	
Nom.	rex	reges	civis	cives	mare	maria
Gen.	regis	regum	civis	civium	maris	marium
Dat.	regi	regibus	civi	civibus	mari	maribus
Acc.	regem	reges	civem	cives	mare	maria
Abl.	rege	regibus	cive	civibus	mari	maribus
Voc.	rex	reges	civis	cives	mare	maria

I-stem signals include neuter nominative in *-e*, *-al*, *-ar*, parisyllabic masculine/feminine forms such as *civis*, and many two-consonant stems. Lexical evidence outranks a guessed shortcut.

4.5 Fourth and fifth declensions

spiritus, -us m.			cornu, -us n.		dies, -ei m./f.	
	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.
Nom.	spiritus	spiritus	cornu	cornua	dies	dies
Gen.	spiritus	spirituum	cornus	cornuum	diei	dierum
Dat.	spiritui	spiritibus	cornu	cornibus	diei	diebus
Acc.	spiritum	spiritus	cornu	cornua	diem	dies
Abl.	spiritu	spiritibus	cornu	cornibus	die	diebus
Voc.	spiritus	spiritus	cornu	cornua	dies	dies

Frequent irregular nouns: notable plural forms of *Deus* include nominative/vocative *dii/dei/di*, genitive *deorum/deum*, dative and ablative *diis/deis/dis*, and accusative *deos*. *Iesus* is normally *Iesus*, *Iesu*, *Iesu*, *Iesum*, *Iesu*, *Iesu*; *vis* has plural *vires*, *virium*, *viribus*, *vires*, *viribus*, *vires*; *domus* mixes second- and fourth-declension forms.

CHAPTER 5

Adjectives and adverbs

Definition — adjective. A word that attributes a quality, class, amount, or identity to a noun or pronoun and agrees with it in gender, number, and case. An adjective may be attributive, predicative, or used substantively.

Definition — attributive, predicate, and substantive adjective. An **attributive** adjective directly modifies a noun; a **predicate** adjective is asserted of a subject or object through the predicate; a **substantive** adjective stands without an expressed noun and is understood as “the person(s)” or “the thing(s)” having the quality.

Definition — adverb. An indeclinable word that modifies a verb, adjective, another adverb, or an entire assertion. Because it does not modify a noun as an adjective does, it does not agree in gender, number, and case.

An adjective agrees with its noun in gender, number, and case, not necessarily in visible ending or declension.

5.1 First/second and third-declension adjectives

	Masculine	Feminine	Neuter
Nom. sg.	bonus	bona	bonum
Gen. sg.	boni	bonæ	boni
Dat. sg.	bono	bonæ	bono
Acc. sg.	bonum	bonam	bonum
Abl. sg.	bono	bona	bono
Nom. pl.	boni	bonæ	bona
Gen. pl.	bonorum	bonarum	bonorum
Dat./abl. pl.	bonis	bonis	bonis
Acc. pl.	bonos	bonas	bona

Third-declension models: *fidelis*, *fidele* (two termination) and *felix*, *felicis* (one termination). Their genitive plural normally ends *-ium*, ablative singular *-i*, and neuter plural *-ia*.

5.2 Comparison

Comparative: stem + *-ior* (m./f.), *-ius* (n.), declined like a third-declension consonant stem. Superlative: stem + *-issimus*, *-a*, *-um*; many *-er* adjectives use *-rimus*, and several *-lis* adjectives use *-limus*.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Adverb
bonus	melior, melius	optimus	bene, melius, optime
malus	peior, peius	pessimus	male, peius, pessime
magnus	maior, maius	maximus	magnopere / magis / maxime
parvus	minor, minus	minimus	paulum/parum, minus, minime
multus	plus, pluris (n. sg.); plures, plura	plurimus	multum, plus, plurimum

The ablative may express the standard after a comparative; *quam* may instead introduce an explicitly parallel case.

CHAPTER 6

Pronouns

Definition — pronoun. A word whose reference is recovered from the speech situation, the surrounding text, or an antecedent. Parsing a pronoun therefore requires both its morphology and a defensible account of what it refers to.

6.1 Personal and reflexive

Definition — reflexive pronoun. A pronoun that refers back to the subject of its own clause or governing point of view. Latin third-person *sui*, *sibi*, *se* is reflexive and has no nominative; a non-reflexive third-person reference normally uses another pronoun.

	ego	tu	sui	nos	vos
Nom.	ego	tu	—	nos	vos
Gen.	mei	tui	sui	nostri/nostrum	vestri/vestrum
Dat.	mihi	tibi	sibi	nobis	vobis
Acc.	me	te	se	nos	vos
Abl.	me	te	se	nobis	vobis

sui, *sibi*, *se* has no nominative and normally refers to the subject of its own clause or governing thought. Possessives *meus*, *tuus*, *suus*, *noster*, *vester* decline as adjectives; *suus* is reflexive.

6.2 Demonstrative and determinative systems

	is, ea, id			hic, hæc, hoc			ille, illa, illud		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom. sg.	is	ea	id	hic	hæc	hoc	ille	illa	illud
Gen. sg.	eius	eius	eius	huius	huius	huius	illius	illius	illius
Dat. sg.	ei	ei	ei	huic	huic	huic	illi	illi	illi
Acc. sg.	eum	eam	id	hunc	hanc	hoc	illum	illam	illud
Abl. sg.	eo	ea	eo	hoc	hac	hoc	illo	illa	illo
Nom. pl.	ii/ei	eæ	ea	hi	hæ	hæc	illi	illæ	illa
Gen. pl.	eorum	earum	eorum	horum	harum	horum	illorum	illarum	illorum
Dat. pl.	iis/eis	iis/eis	iis/eis	his	his	his	illis	illis	illis
Acc. pl.	eos	eas	ea	hos	has	hæc	illos	illas	illa
Abl. pl.	iis/eis	iis/eis	iis/eis	his	his	his	illis	illis	illis

iste, *ista*, *istud* follows *ille*. *ipse*, *ipsa*, *ipsum* intensifies or distinguishes and follows the same genitive/dative pattern. *idem*, *eadem*, *idem* is *is* plus *-dem*; forms assimilate, e.g. *eundem*, *eandem*, *eorundem*.

6.3 Relative and interrogative

	Singular			Plural		
	m.	f.	n.	m.	f.	n.
Nom.	qui	quæ	quod	qui	quæ	quæ
Gen.	cuius	cuius	cuius	quorum	quarum	quorum
Dat.	cui	cui	cui	quibus	quibus	quibus
Acc.	quem	quam	quod	quos	quas	quæ
Abl.	quo	qua	quo	quibus	quibus	quibus

A relative pronoun takes gender and number from its antecedent but case from its own function. Interrogative *quis*, *quid* asks identity; adjectival *qui*, *quæ*, *quod* asks which. Indefinite and generalized systems include *aliquis*, *quidam*, *quisque*, and *quicumque*; the separate negative indefinites are *nemo* and *nihil*.

CHAPTER 7

Verbs

Definition — verb. A word that predicates an action, process, occurrence, or state. A finite Latin verb expresses person, number, tense, voice, and mood; its lexical entry also supplies the stems needed for non-finite forms.

7.1 Principal parts and stems

Definition — principal parts. A verb's conventional citation forms, chosen so that the present, perfect, and supine or participial stems can be recovered. They are lexical facts to be learned with the verb, not four interchangeable translations.

From *laudo*, *laudare*, *laudavi*, *laudatum* obtain:

- present stem *lauda-*: present system, infinitive, imperative, present participle, gerund, gerundive;
- perfect stem *laudav-*: perfect-system active; and
- supine stem *laudat-*: perfect passive participle, perfect-system passive, future active participle, supine.

Conjugation models are *laudare*, *monere*, *regere*, *capere*, *audire*. Third *-io* verbs combine a third-conjugation infinitive with an *-i-* in parts of the present system.

7.2 Personal endings

Definition — personal ending. Inflectional material that marks the person and number of a finite verb and, in the ordinary system, helps mark active or passive voice. The ending often makes a separate subject pronoun unnecessary.

	Active	Passive
1 sg.	-o/-m	-or/-r
2 sg.	-s	-ris/-re
3 sg.	-t	-tur
1 pl.	-mus	-mur
2 pl.	-tis	-mini
3 pl.	-nt	-ntur

7.3 Present indicative active

	I	II	III	III-io	IV
1 sg.	laudo	moneo	rego	capio	audio
2 sg.	laudas	mones	regis	capis	audis
3 sg.	laudat	monet	regit	capit	audit
1 pl.	laudamus	monemus	regimus	capimus	audimus
2 pl.	laudatis	monetis	regitis	capitis	auditis
3 pl.	laudent	monent	regunt	capiunt	audiunt

Imperfect inserts *-ba-* (III/III-io/IV use *-eba-*): *laudabam, monebam, regebam, capiebam, audiebam*. Future I/II uses *-bo, -bis, -bit, -bimus, -bitis, -bunt*; III and III-io/IV use *-am, -es, -et, -emus, -etis, -ent*.

7.4 Present-system passive

Replace active personal endings with passive endings: *laudor, laudaris, laudatur, laudamur, laudamini, laudantur*; *regor, regeris, regitur, regimur, regimini, reguntur*. Imperfect and future retain their tense markers: *laudabar, laudabor, regar*.

7.5 Perfect-system active

Definition — perfect system. The set of Latin forms built on the perfect stem in the active and expressed periphrastically with a perfect passive participle in the passive. It includes perfect, pluperfect, and future perfect forms; the name identifies a morphological system, not one compulsory English rendering.

Add these endings to the perfect stem:

	1 sg.	2 sg.	3 sg.	1 pl.	2 pl.	3 pl.
Perfect	-i	-isti	-it	-imus	-istis	-erunt/-ere
Pluperfect	-eram	-eras	-erat	-eramus	-eratis	-erant
Future perfect	-ero	-eris	-erit	-erimus	-eritis	-erint

Example: *laudavi, laudaveram, laudavero*. Perfect stems vary and must be learned from principal parts: *dixi* from *dico*, *feci* from *facio*, *veni* from *venio*.

7.6 Perfect-system passive

Use the perfect passive participle, agreeing with the subject, plus the corresponding tense of *sum*: *laudatus est* (he was/has been praised), *laudata erat*, *laudati erunt*. The participle carries gender and number; *sum* carries person and tense.

7.7 Subjunctive formation

Definition — subjunctive. A finite verb mood used in independent wishes, commands, possibilities, and deliberation and in many kinds of subordinate clause. The form identifies the mood; conjunction, governing expression, sequence, and context identify the particular use.

Present active theme vowels: first conjugation *e*; others normally *a*: *laudem*, *moneam*, *regam*, *capiam*, *audiam*. Add passive endings for *lauder*, *monear*, etc.

Imperfect: present active infinitive + personal endings: *laudarem*, *monerem*, *regerem*, *caperem*, *audirem*; passive *laudarer*, etc.

Perfect active: perfect stem + *-erim*, *-eris*, *-erit*, *-erimus*, *-eritis*, *-erint*. Pluperfect active: perfect active infinitive + endings, *laudavisse*. Perfect and pluperfect passive use perfect passive participle + present or imperfect subjunctive of *sum*: *laudatus sit*, *laudatus esset*.

7.8 Non-finite forms

Definition — infinitive. A non-finite verbal form that can complete another verb or head an infinitive construction. Its tense normally expresses time relative to its governing verb, and it does not agree with a subject in person and number.

Definition — participle. A verbal adjective: it retains tense-relative and voice properties of a verb while agreeing with a noun or pronoun in gender, number, and case.

Definition — gerund and gerundive. A **gerund** is an active verbal noun with only oblique singular forms. A **gerundive** is a passive verbal adjective that agrees with a noun and often expresses necessity or propriety. Similar spelling does not make their syntax interchangeable.

Do not confuse an infinitive with a participle. An infinitive does not agree with a noun in gender, number, and case; a participle does. Both have relative time and voice, so translation by an English verbal form alone is not enough to classify them.

Form	Model	Relative time / use
Present active infinitive	laudare	simultaneous; to praise
Present passive infinitive	laudari	simultaneous; to be praised
Perfect active infinitive	laudavisse	prior; to have praised

Form	Model	Relative time / use
Perfect passive infinitive	laudatus esse	prior; to have been praised
Future active infinitive	laudaturus esse	subsequent/intended
Future passive infinitive	laudatum iri	rare; subsequent passive
Present active participle	laudans, laudantis	contemporaneous active
Perfect passive participle	laudatus, -a, -um	prior passive
Future active participle	laudaturus, -a, -um	subsequent/intended active
Gerundive	laudandus, -a, -um	necessity/propriety; passive verbal adjective
Gerund	laudandi, laudando, laudandum, laudando	active verbal noun; no nominative
Supine in <i>-um</i>	laudatum	motion to do something
Supine in <i>-u</i>	laudatu	respect, usually with an adjective

7.9 Commands

Definition — imperative. The finite mood specialized for direct commands or requests. Latin can also express commands by independent subjunctives and negative-command constructions, so commanding force does not prove that a form is morphologically imperative.

Present active imperatives: *lauda/laudate, mone/monete, rege/regite, cape/capite, audi/audite*. Present passive: *laudare/laudamini*. Negative commands often use *noli/nolite* + infinitive or *ne* + subjunctive. The perfect subjunctive is common in prohibitions; the present is also found, especially in petitions such as *ne nos inducas*. Third-person commands may use the present subjunctive.

7.10 Irregular and high-frequency verbs

sum, esse, fui, futurus

	1 sg.	2 sg.	3 sg.	1 pl.	2 pl.	3 pl.
Pres. ind.	sum	es	est	sumus	estis	sunt
Imperf. ind.	eram	eras	erat	eramus	eratis	erant
Fut. ind.	ero	eris	erit	erimus	eritis	erunt
Pres. subj.	sim	sis	sit	simus	sitis	sint
Imperf. subj.	essem	esses	esset	essemus	essetis	essent

Perfect system: *fui, fueram, fuero; fuerim, fuisset*. *possum, posse, potui* combines *pot-* with forms of *sum*, assimilating to *pos-* before *s*: *possum, potes, potest, possumus, potestis, possunt*.

Verb	Principal parts	Diagnostic forms
go	<i>eo, ire, ii/ivi, itum</i>	<i>eo, is, it, imus, itis, eunt</i> ; subj. <i>eam</i> ; imperf. <i>ibam</i>
bear	<i>fero, ferre, tuli, latum</i>	<i>fero, fers, fert</i> ; passive <i>feror</i> ; imperative <i>fer</i>
wish	<i>volo, velle, volui</i>	<i>volo, vis, vult, volumus, vultis, volunt</i> ; subj. <i>velim</i>
refuse	<i>nolo, nolle, nolui</i>	<i>nolo, non vis, non vult</i> ; imperative <i>noli/nolite</i>
prefer	<i>malo, malle, malui</i>	<i>malo, mavis, mavult</i>
become/be made	<i>fio, fieri, factus sum</i>	active-looking present, passive of <i>facio</i> where that verb lacks a regular passive
eat	<i>edo, edere, edi, esum</i>	regular forms plus <i>es, est, estis</i> ; context distinguishes from <i>sum</i>
say	<i>aio; inquam</i>	defective quotation formulas

7.11 Deponents and semi-deponents

Definition — deponent and semi-deponent verb. A **deponent** verb has passive-form morphology but active or middle sense throughout its finite system. A **semi-deponent** uses active forms in the present system and deponent forms in the perfect system. Morphological voice and lexical sense must therefore be reported separately.

Deponents have passive morphology with active or middle sense: *loquor, loqui, locutus sum; sequor, sequi, secutus sum; patior, pati, passus sum; morior, mori, mortuus sum*. Their perfect participle is normally active in meaning. Semi-deponents such as *audeo, audere, ausus sum* use active present-system and deponent perfect.

CHAPTER 8

Case syntax at a glance

Definition — case syntax. The study of why a nominal form has a particular case in its construction. A complete explanation names both the case and the relation or governing word that licenses it.

8.1 Genitive

Possession (*gratia Dei*); partitive whole (*unus discipulorum*); description (*vir magnæ fidei*); objective/subjective relation (*amor Dei*); value; and complement with adjectives or verbs of memory, accusation, and fullness. Decide from the head word and meaning, not the English preposition alone.

8.2 Dative

Indirect object; reference or advantage; possession with *sum*; purpose, often paired with reference (double dative); agent with the passive periphrastic; and complement of compounds or adjectives. For example, *nobis saluti* combines a dative of reference with a dative of purpose.

8.3 Accusative

Direct object; subject of an infinitive; duration/extent; motion toward with or without a preposition; exclamation; and retained object in some passives. Never assign “direct object” before checking whether an infinitive depends on a verb of saying, knowing, perceiving, or thinking.

8.4 Ablative

The ablative gathers three historical relations:

- **separation/source:** from, without, deprived of, comparison;
- **instrument/association:** means, agent with *a/ab*, manner, accompaniment, cause, price, quality; and
- **location:** place where, time when/within which, circumstance.

Definition — ablative absolute. A grammatically self-contained ablative phrase, normally a noun or pronoun plus an agreeing participle, or two nominals with an understood form of *sum*. It supplies background circumstance without serving as an argument of the main predicate: *Christo duce*, “with Christ as leader.” Its temporal, causal, concessive, or other logical relation must be inferred from context.

CHAPTER 9

Clause syntax at a glance

Definition — main and subordinate clause. A **main clause** is not syntactically dependent on another clause in its sentence. A **subordinate clause** functions within or in relation to a governing clause as a modifier, complement, circumstance, or dependent assertion.

Definition — clause construction. A recurring combination of form, syntactic relation, and contextual force—not a translation attached to one signal word. To classify a construction, identify its governing expression, connector, verb form, internal syntax, and contribution to the larger sentence.

Construction	Signals	Decision
Relative clause	relative pronoun + finite verb	pronoun agrees with antecedent in gender/number; its case comes from its clause.
Indirect statement	head verb + acc. subject + infinitive	infinitive tense is relative to head verb; do not translate the accusative as object.
Purpose	<i>ut/ne</i> + subj.; relative + subj.	intended aim; commonly follows action capable of purpose.
Result	<i>ut/ut non</i> + subj.; often <i>tam, ita, sic, tantus</i>	actual or represented consequence.
Indirect command	command/request verb + <i>ut/ne</i> + subj.	content of what is commanded or requested.
Substantive clause	<i>ut/ne, quod, quin</i> etc. functioning as noun	ask what syntactic slot the entire clause fills.

Construction	Signals	Decision
Fear	fear verb + <i>ne</i> (that) or <i>ut</i> (that not) + subj.	keep the Latin polarity separate from English idiom.
<i>cum</i> clause	<i>cum</i> + ind./subj.	indicative often temporal; subjunctive may be circumstantial, causal, or concessive.
Condition	<i>si/nisi</i> protasis + apodosis	classify from both clauses: open, future, ideal, or contrary-to-fact.
Relative characteristic	relative + subj.	characterizes a type or essential quality rather than merely identifying.
Concessive	<i>quamvis, licet, etsi, cum</i>	concession balanced by main assertion; mood depends on construction.
Proviso	<i>dum, modo, dummodo</i> + subj.	provided that, often with negative <i>ne</i> .
Comparison	<i>ut, sicut, quasi, tamquam</i>	distinguish literal analogy, manner, and represented thought.

Do not confuse purpose with result. A purpose clause gives an intended aim and normally uses *ut/ne*; a result clause gives a consequence and normally uses *ut/ut non*, often anticipated by a degree word such as *ita* or *tantus*. Ask whether the governing action is directed toward the outcome or is presented as producing it.

Do not confuse purpose with indirect command. Both may have *ut/ne* with the subjunctive. A purpose clause modifies an action by giving its aim; an indirect command supplies the content required by a verb of ordering, asking, urging, or permitting.

Do not confuse a direct object with an accusative subject of an infinitive. Both may be accusative. The direct object completes the governing finite verb; an accusative subject belongs semantically and syntactically with its infinitive inside indirect statement or another infinitive construction.

Do not confuse an ordinary relative clause with a relative clause of characteristic. An ordinary relative with the indicative normally identifies or reports a fact about its antecedent. A characteristic relative with the subjunctive presents the antecedent as a kind of person or thing marked by the stated quality; context, not the relative pronoun alone, decides.

Do not confuse a substantive clause with an adverbial clause. A substantive clause fills a nominal slot required or licensed by a governing expression; an adverbial clause modifies the larger predication by expressing such a relation as purpose, cause, time, concession, or condition.

9.1 Sequence and relative tense

Definition — sequence of tenses. The patterned relation between the tense of a subjunctive in a dependent clause and the temporal viewpoint of its leading verb. Primary sequence normally uses present or perfect subjunctive; historic sequence normally uses imperfect or pluperfect. Sequence narrows the temporal relation but does not classify the clause.

Definition — leading verb. The governing finite verb whose temporal viewpoint sets a dependent subjunctive's sequence or supplies the reference point for an infinitive's relative time. The leading verb need not be the first printed word.

Primary leading verbs normally take present subjunctive for same/subsequent action and perfect for prior action. Historic leading verbs normally take imperfect for same/subsequent action and pluperfect for prior action. Liturgical prayer can preserve a perfect with present force, shift viewpoint, or use a subjunctive independently; classify the clause before mechanically applying a sequence chart.

9.2 Independent subjunctives

Definition — independent subjunctive. A subjunctive that serves in a main clause rather than being required by a subordinating construction. Person, tense, negative particle, and discourse setting distinguish jussive, hortatory, optative, potential, deliberative, and prohibitive forces.

Jussive (let), hortatory (let us), optative (would that), potential (may/might), deliberative (what am I to do?), and prohibitive uses do not depend on a subordinating conjunction. Their force comes from person, tense, particles, and discourse setting.

CHAPTER 10

Word order and reconstruction

Definition — word order. The arrangement of constituents in a sentence. Latin inflection permits more variation than English, but an order is not random: it can mark information structure, contrast, balance, rhythm, or connection.

Definition — hyperbaton. The marked separation of words that belong together syntactically, often an agreeing modifier and noun. Recover the relation from compatible morphology and sense before asking what the separation emphasizes.

Definition — ellipsis. The omission of a grammatically recoverable element. Reconstruction may display the supplied element in square brackets, but may not invent a word merely to make the Latin resemble ordinary English order.

Latin endings carry relations that English often carries by position. Marked order may frame a sentence, separate agreeing words (hyperbaton), place a contrast first, postpone a climactic verb, or arrange balanced members.

For a difficult liturgical sentence, rewrite without changing forms:

1. finite verb beside its explicit or supplied subject;
2. direct and indirect complements beside the governing verb;
3. each modifier beside its head noun;
4. each prepositional phrase in brackets;
5. subordinate clauses on separate indented lines; and
6. omitted forms in square brackets only when grammar requires them.

Then return to the printed order and ask what the original arrangement foregrounds. Reconstruction is scaffolding, not a claim that Latin secretly uses English order.

CHAPTER 11

Liturgical genre quick map

Definition — genre. A recurring kind of text defined by communicative task and convention. Genre predicts likely architecture and omissions; it does not override the morphology and syntax of the particular text.

Definition — register. A variety of language associated with a use or setting. The Missal brings liturgical, biblical, theological, and rubrical registers into one book, each with partly distinct vocabulary and habits.

Genre	Frequent architecture	Watch for
Collect	address; relative/participial ground; imperative petition; purpose; conclusion	distant antecedents, first-person plural objects, compact abstract nouns
Secret	petition over offerings; sacrificial means/purpose	ablatives of means, <i>munera/dona/hostia</i> , sacramental causality
Postcommunion	completed reception; requested effect	perfect participles, <i>quæsumus</i> , result/purpose ambiguity
Epistle	connective argument, exhortation, quotation	long periods, accusative-infinitive, participles, pronoun chains
Gospel	narrative plus direct speech	tense shifts, recurrent coordination (including source-language patterns only when comparison proves them), historic present, quotation boundaries
Chant proper	excerpted scriptural or poetic line	omitted verbs, parallelism, altered context, unusual order
Preface	thanksgiving judgment + relative praise + angelic conclusion	one long sentence, relative chains, balanced accumulations
Canon	first-person plural petition, commemoration, relative clauses	remote objects, apposition, formulaic participles, coordinated imperatives
Rubric	impersonal directions, participles, gerundives	specialized vocabulary, elliptical subject, future/passive obligation

CHAPTER 12

Core Missal lexicon

Definition — lexicon. The vocabulary of a language, author, register, or corpus. A useful lexicon records a lemma with its inflectional information, construction, and range of senses rather than pairing it with one English word.

The following is a retrieval list, not a set of English replacements. Learn principal parts and constructions, then refine sense from context.

12.1 Nouns

altare, -is n. — altar; 3rd. often with *ad* or *in*

anima, -æ f. — soul, life; 1st. distinguish from *animus*

apostolus, -i m. — apostle; 2nd. title and common noun

auxilium, -i n. — help; 2nd. often governed by petition verbs

benedictio, -onis f. — blessing; 3rd. from *benedico*

cælum, -i n.; pl. cæli, -orum m. — heaven, sky; 2nd. heteroclite plural frequently “heavens”

caritas, -atis f. — charity, love; 3rd. theological virtue

cor, cordis n. — heart; 3rd. stem *cord-*

corpus, corporis n. — body; 3rd. stem *corpor-*

culpa, -æ f. — fault; 1st. *mea culpa*

dies, diei m./f. — day; 5th. gender varies with sense/usage

discipulus, -i m. — disciple; 2nd. feminine *discipula*

donum, -i n. — gift; 2nd. compare *munus*

ecclesia, -æ f. — Church, assembly; 1st. Christian semantic range

fides, fidei f. — faith, fidelity; 5th. not *fidēs* in print

filius, -i m. — son; 2nd. vocative *fili*

gloria, -æ f. — glory; 1st. praise, splendor, heavenly glory

gratia, -æ f. — grace, favor, thanks; 1st. sense from construction

hostia, -æ f. — sacrificial victim/oblation; 1st. not *hostis*, “enemy”

laus, laudis f. — praise; 3rd. stem *laud-*

lex, legis f. — law; 3rd. stem *leg-*

lumen, luminis n. — light; 3rd. stem *lumin-*

misericordia, -æ f. — mercy; 1st. frequent divine attribute
mors, mortis f. — death; 3rd. i-stem tendency.

munus, muneris n. — gift, duty, offering; 3rd. context-sensitive

nomen, nominis n. — name; 3rd. stem *nomin-*

opus, operis n. — work, deed; 3rd. stem *oper-*

pax, pacis f. — peace; 3rd. stem *pac-*

peccatum, -i n. — sin; 2nd. from *pecco*

populus, -i m. — people; 2nd. collective singular

prex, precis f. — prayer, entreaty; 3rd. often plural *preces*

sacrificium, -i n. — sacrifice, offering; 2nd. sense from context

salus, salutis f. — health, salvation; 3rd. sense broader than safety

sanguis, sanguinis m. — blood; 3rd. stem *sanguin-*

servus, -i m. — servant; 2nd. common female lexical counterpart *ancilla*; regular *serva* also exists

spiritus, -us m. — spirit, breath; 4th. genitive *spiritus*

tempus, temporis n. — time; 3rd. stem *tempor-*

verbum, -i n. — word; 2nd. *Verbum* as divine title

vita, -æ f. — life; 1st. temporal or eternal

12.2 Verbs

accipio, -ere, accepi, acceptum — receive; III-io. also take, accept

adoro, -are, -avi, -atum — adore; I. takes accusative

aperio, -ire, aperui, apertum — open; IV. stem changes

benedico, -ere, benedixi, benedictum — bless; III. dative in older use; accusative also occurs later

cognosco, -ere, cognovi, cognitum — know, recognize; III. perfect may express acquired knowledge

concedo, -ere, concessi, concessum — grant, yield; III. often prayer head

credo, -ere, credidi, creditum — believe, entrust; III. dative person; *in + acc.* in Creed

dico, -ere, dixi, dictum — say; III. indirect statement

dimitto, -ere, dimisi, dimissum — send away, forgive; III. meaning from object

do, dare, dedi, datum — give; I irregular. short *a* except *das, da*

facio, -ere, feci, factum — make, do; III-io. passive present system *fio*

glorifico, -are, -avi, -atum — glorify; I. Christian formation

habeo, -ere, habui, habitum — have, hold; II. many idioms

largior, -iri, largitus sum — bestow; IV deponent. active meaning

laudo, -are, -avi, -atum — praise; I. regular model

misereor, misereri, miseritus/misertus sum — have mercy;

II deponent. imperative <i>miserere</i> ; classical genitive, with liturgical dative in <i>miserere nobis</i>	<i>quæso, quæsumus</i> — I/we ask, pray; defective. parenthetical petition forms; distinct from <i>quæro</i>
<i>offero, offerre, obtuli, oblatum</i> — offer; irregular. compound of <i>fero</i>	<i>redimo, -ere, redemi, redemptum</i> — redeem; III. stem <i>redempt-</i>
<i>oro, -are, -avi, -atum</i> — pray, entreat; I. person/object or clause	<i>rego, -ere, rexi, rectum</i> — rule, direct; III. petition verb
<i>perduco, -ere, perduxi, perductum</i> — lead through, bring; III. <i>ad + acc.</i>	<i>salvo, -are, -avi, -atum</i> — save; I. later/ecclesiastical
<i>perficio, -ere, perfeci, perfectum</i> — complete, accomplish; III-io. compare adjective	<i>sanctifico, -are, -avi, -atum</i> — sanctify; I. Christian formation
<i>præsto, -are, præstiti, præstitum</i> — provide, grant, excel; I. formulaic prayer verb	<i>sequor, sequi, secutus sum</i> — follow; III deponent. accusative object
<i>quæro, -ere, quæsi, quæsitum</i> — seek, ask; III. takes an object or indirect question	<i>tribuo, -ere, tribui, tributum</i> — grant, assign; III. person often dative
	<i>venio, -ire, veni, ventum</i> — come; IV. perfect has long-vowel distinction not printed

12.3 Connectors and particles

Form	Usual force	Reading caution
<i>autem</i>	but, moreover, now	commonly postpositive; often marks a discourse turn rather than strong opposition
<i>enim</i>	for, indeed	postpositive explanation
<i>ergo/igitur</i>	therefore	<i>igitur</i> often postpositive
<i>nam/namque</i>	for	introduces explanation
<i>quoniam/quia</i>	because, since; that	can introduce cause or content
<i>ut</i>	as, when, that, so that	mood and governing context decide
<i>ne</i>	lest, that not	negative purpose, indirect command, or related subjunctive construction
<i>-ne</i>	yes/no question; whether in an indirect alternative	interrogative enclitic attached to the questioned word
<i>cum</i>	with; when/since/although	case or following clause decides
<i>dum</i>	while, until, provided that	tense/mood varies by force
<i>quasi/tamquam</i>	as if, as though	may mark represented comparison
<i>etiam/quoque</i>	also, even	<i>quoque</i> normally follows its focus
<i>neque/nec</i>	and not, nor	coordinates a negative member
<i>non solum...sed etiam</i>	not only...but also	preserve the parallelism

CHAPTER 13

Parsing checklist

Definition — parse. To identify a form’s lemma and morphology, locate it in its clause, state its syntactic function, and cite the evidence that rules out competing analyses. Parsing is an argued analysis, not an ending label.

For every noun or adjective, state lemma, declension, gender where lexical, case, number, syntactic function, and agreement/government evidence. For every verb, state lemma/principal parts, person/number or nominal form, tense, voice, mood, clause, subject, complements, and contextual force. For every pronoun, state antecedent/reference as well as form and function.

Before accepting a reading, ask:

1. Does every personal finite verb have an explicit or defensibly supplied subject, or is the construction genuinely impersonal?
2. Does every adjective or participle have a possible head?
3. Does every governed case fit its preposition, verb, adjective, or noun?
4. Does every relative pronoun have an antecedent or a defensible free/substantival use, and does it have an in-clause function?
5. Have infinitives and participles been assigned relative time and voice?
6. Does each subjunctive have a classified use rather than merely a label?
7. Does the final sense fit the genre and wider source context?

Part II

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Companion role

This publication is EL-REFERENCE, *Reference Grammar and Core Missal Lexicon*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It gathers the curriculum's definitions, paradigms, syntax summaries, genre map, core lexicon, and parsing checklist. Module-local reference cards remain the sufficient first lookup for their own packets.

It supports the 46 learning modules but does not replace their prerequisite, practice, enrichment, and mastery sequence. Consult it after an unaided hypothesis; do not read it as a substitute for module practice.

1.2 Corpus, review, and rights

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. This is a language-study aid, not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment.

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; this leaf's companion map records its selection. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. This publication therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released PDF.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T20:48:54Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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